

connection or a cable. The devices are paired, and the files are transferred from within the app. Apart from that, the app does not have any extra bells and whistles. There are no file management features, or the ability to use cloud storage. The explorer for the files has tabs that automatically bins content by type, such as videos, photos and music.

sendanywhere

Sendanywhere is a powerful little app that allows users to transfer files between two devices, with or without an internet connection. The files load up immediately after you fire up the app, and the user experience is blazing fast. From the manager screen, you can select multiple files and then choose send. Here you will get a QR code to transfer the files, a link that can be shareable, or the option to connect locally to another device without the internet. The link or code can be sent over IM clients to another device. The utility of this app is that it works just as well on devices that are far away as well as closer together. The link for sharing the file expires after the transfer, and the files are not stored anywhere in the cloud. This is a fast, secure and simple way to transfer files between devices. The app works on computers, and smartphones from both Android and iOS just as well.

SCANNER APPS

For the most part, you do not really need a separate app to scan documents. The default camera apps in most phones now have a document scanning feature, and many of them support the features of scanning apps such as QR code reading. The user experience with scanning apps is very tricky, and not perfect. All the apps use AR components for guiding the user through the scanning process, use AI in various ways, and process the captured image excessively. All of these means that for the end user the experience is never smooth. Considering the extra tech used, it might actually be more problematic to "scan" a document than simply snapping a picture.

So when do you need to use these scanning applications? You need one of these if you want to integrate offline docs into your note taking or journaling system. In this case, Evernote is the way

to go. Another reason to use camera scanning apps is if you want an easy way to convert physical documents into PDF files using your smartphone. If you need to scan business cards and add them directly to your contacts, go for Evernote or ABYYY. Note that ABYYY is very good at recognising the text, but does not allow you to save the information in its own Cardholder as well as Contacts, without



sendanywhere gives you QR codes for easy transfer

an option to save only in Contacts. Adobe Scan is a great, free version that does allow you to save contact information from Business cards directly to Contacts. If you work a lot with Microsoft Office or Adobe software, then Office Lens and Adobe scan are powerful companion apps for these software. If you want to use an app to capture and edit text, the best option is Google Translate. Let us take a look at these scanning apps, which are alternatives to the banned CamScanner app.

Adobe Scan

Adobe Scan is the software to use if you want to convert documents, forms and photographs into PDF files. There are four modes available in the app, Whiteboard, Form, Document and Business Card. The hero feature of this app is the ability to capture a form, convert it into a PDF document that you can fill and then

share digitally, or take a print out and submit. However, considering the wide variety of lines, boxes and fields used in local forms, this feature does not work very well, for say an Indian Learner's License application. The form feature also does not work in the horizontal mode. When it does work though, it works very well. When it comes to text, you can annotate in Acrobat, or use the scanned document as every other PDF. If you are using Acrobat Pro, the text gets recognised and formatted, and is editable.

Users can scan multiple pages and add them to a single PDF file, and reorder the pages within the app itself. There is a cleanup option that is helpful in removing blemishes, scratches, creases and even a coffee stain. You can also print directly from the app to a connected WiFi printer.

Most of the business card scanning apps have a number of artificial impediments in the process. They either force you to use their own contact saving software, or go in for a pro subscription. Not Adobe Scan. Here, you can just scan a business card, and save the information to your contacts. This is simple and straightforward, the way it should be. If you want to add contact information from a stack of business cards to your phone, then this is definitely the software that you have to go for. The OCR is accurate, and moreover, you can save all the business cards as PDFs, or images within the app. You can also add the contact information directly to the intelligent assistant on your phone, if you so desire.

PhotoScan

PhotoScan by Google Photos is meant for the sole purpose of scanning photos, and the most important feature is the glare removal. This means that if you have lights around on a glossy print, the AI removes glare from the photo. The process of capturing an image is a little tricky, and there are four guide points that show up confusingly in the middle of the photo instead of the corners. This is by design, as what the app does is combine four images into a single photo. The movement of the phone prevents the final image from capturing the glare, as the portions with the glare are automatically removed. You have to move the smartphone to cover these four circles, and be careful not to pan or tilt